BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Wed 28 Oct 2026, 23:50 Malaysia time (15:50 UTC)

BTC ~ $81,000

CoinDesk/CoinGecko, Oct 28: +1.5 to 1.9% 24h, Oct -2.7%

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, slight upside lean into Fed	**Next 24h:** $79,500 - $82,500	**Key floor:** $79,100 (Oct 24 low), then $78,000 max pain	**Big event:** FOMC 02:00 MYT Thu; PCE+GDP 20:30 MYT Thu

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

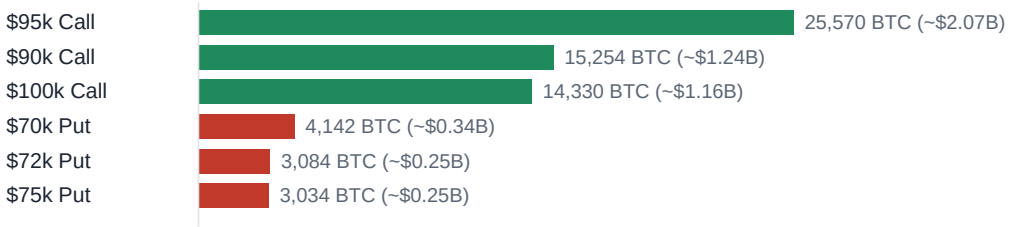
- **Next expiry:** Deribit daily, **Thu 29 Oct 4:00pm MYT** (08:00 UTC). Strike-level data for this daily could not be read this run; dailies are normally a small fraction of the monthly.
- **The one that matters:** the **Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm MYT monthly** (also this week's weekly): ~135,000 BTC, **~$10.9B notional**, put/call **0.53**, max pain **$78,000** (Deribit, Oct 28).
- After that: weekly Fri 6 Nov 4:00pm MYT, monthly Fri 27 Nov (26,779 contracts on Oct 17), quarterly/annual Fri 25 Dec (~$10B, max pain ~$75k as of Oct 1).

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
Thu 29 Oct (daily)	Not readable this run	-	Small; no big wall expected, but the FOMC move will hit just before it
Fri 30 Oct (weekly + monthly)	$95,000 Call	25,570 BTC (~$2.07B)*	Far above price - mostly expires worthless; caps only a squeeze
Fri 30 Oct (weekly + monthly)	$70,000 Put	4,142 BTC (~$0.34B)*	Tail protection; matters only on a crash below $75k

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Thu 29 Oct 4:00pm (daily)	n/a	n/a	n/a	Not readable this run
Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm (monthly)	~$10.9B	0.53	$78,000 (Deribit)	Calls $95k / $90k / $100k; Puts $70k / $72k / $75k
Fri 6 Nov 4:00pm (weekly)	n/a	n/a	n/a	Not yet published
Fri 27 Nov 4:00pm (monthly)	26,779 contracts (Oct 17)	n/a	n/a	n/a

Fri 30 Oct monthly - largest open interest by strike (Deribit, Oct 17 snapshot; USD at ~$81k)



How options affect the market now

- **Pull toward max pain:** spot (~$81k) sits ~$3k above the $78,000 max pain. The pull is weak with two days left, but it argues against a clean breakout before Friday 4pm MYT.
- **Call-heavy book (P/C 0.53):** the big $90k-$100k calls are far out of the money, so dealer hedging there is small now. They only matter if a squeeze runs above $84-86k, where hedging buys could accelerate the move.
- **Downside acceleration:** put open interest clusters at $75k/$72k/$70k. A break below $79k (Oct 24 low) could bring these into play and dealers selling to hedge could speed the drop.
- **Volatility:** DVOL ~37.3 implies ~1.95% daily move (~$1,600). 7-day ATM IV ~36% vs realized ~27% - a 9-point 'Fed premium' that usually fades after the decision and the Friday expiry.

- **Skew:** 1-week put-call skew fell below 1% (from ~10% a week ago), so short-term fear has eased; 30-day skew still mildly favours puts (-4.6 vol pts, near median).
- **Next-24h expiry (daily):** too small to steer price; the FOMC at 02:00 MYT and PCE/GDP at 20:30 MYT will dominate.

Data note: the Deribit public API could not be reached this run, so strike sizes come from published reports. * Largest-strike OI is the Oct 17 Deribit snapshot (CryptoTicker); notional, P/C and max pain are the Oct 28 Deribit figures. Treat strike sizes as 'largest seen'.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC rebounded from below $80,000 on Oct 27 to ~$81,400 in Asia hours on Oct 28, helped by an AI/chip stock rally (SK Hynix record profit, Kospi +6.6%). Later in the day it traded in the $80,600-81,400 area.
- UTC-day range on Oct 28: ~$80,600 - $81,800. The bounce was mostly short covering: ~75% of recent BTC liquidations were shorts.
- October is still ~-2.7% (from $83,576 on Oct 1). Recent high $84,840 (Oct 21), recent low $79,145 (Oct 24).
- Price sits inside the $80,000-81,500 cost-basis band of ETF holders/treasury firms (Glassnode) - a natural battle zone.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$83,600 - $84,800	Coinspeaker resistance $83,624; Oct 21 swing high $84,840
Resistance 1	$81,600 - $82,000	20-day EMA (~$81.6-81.9k); a daily close above $82k is the upside trigger
Pivot	$80,000 - $81,500	ETF/treasury cost-basis band; 50-day EMA ~$80.8k
Support 1	$79,100 - $79,200	Oct 24 low; close below kills the short-squeeze thesis
Support 2	$77,600 - $78,000	Options max pain $78k; 100-day EMA ~$77.7k; 365-day MA $77.6k
Deep risk	$75,000 - $76,400	200-day EMA ~$76.4k; Strategy cost ~$75.4k; $75k/$72k put strikes

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures open interest	$38.4B (-1.3%); CoinDesk: +1.3% vs volume +7.5%	Little new leverage; CME OI fell 36,545 BTC in October
Funding (BTC perps)	~+0.009% per 8h	Mildly positive, longs not crowded
Liquidations (24h)	$172M total ($116M shorts / $56M longs); BTC ~$57.6M	Short squeeze drove the bounce
Long/short ratio	1.90 (from 2.43)	Retail long bias cooling
Spot BTC ETF flows	+$110M (Mon 26) / +$176M (Tue 27)	Two inflow days after ~-$774M on Oct 22-23; Oct ~-$26M
Exchange netflow	-14,942 BTC (Santiment)	Largest outflow in 5 weeks - less sell supply
Implied vol	DVOL ~37.3; 7d ATM IV ~36%	Fed-week premium; ~1.95% implied daily move
Fear & Greed	51 (Neutral), from 48	Neutral; was 63 a week ago

4. News and macro

- **Fed decision tonight:** statement 02:00 MYT Thu, Chair Kevin Warsh presser 02:30 MYT. Rate 3.75-4.00% after a September hike; markets price ~90-96% hold but ~73-79% odds of a December hike. Hawkish dissents would read as a 'hawkish hold'.
- **Inflation pressure:** CPI at 3.7%; Thursday's September PCE expected 3.6% y/y headline, core 3.1%; Q3 GDP seen ~3.0-3.2%. 10-year yield near 5%, Brent near $115.

- **Geopolitics:** WSJ reports US warned Gulf states to prepare for a 'short, intense' campaign against Iran after the Nov 3 midterms; Houthis claim a strike on Saudi Ras Tanura (unconfirmed). Oil and inflation risk.
- **Risk-on equities:** Asian chip rally (Kospi biggest gain since July, Samsung +9%); S&P 500 +0.6% Tuesday to 7,722.
- **Crypto corporate:** Strategy holds ~848,517 BTC (avg ~$75,446) and paused buys; Strategy and Coinbase Q3 results Thu after US close. Robinhood Q3 crypto revenue -55%.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Thu 29 Oct 02:00 / 02:30	FOMC statement / Warsh press conference
Thu 29 Oct 16:00	Deribit daily BTC options expiry
Thu 29 Oct 20:30	US Sep PCE, Q3 GDP (advance), jobless claims
Fri 30 Oct ~04:00-05:00	Strategy (MSTR) and Coinbase Q3 earnings (after US close)
Fri 30 Oct 16:00	Deribit monthly BTC options expiry (~$10.9B, max pain $78k)
Tue 3 - Wed 4 Nov	US midterm elections / results; possible Iran escalation after
Fri 6 Nov 16:00	Deribit weekly expiry; US October jobs report 21:30
Thu 10 Dec 03:00	Next FOMC decision (Dec 8-9 meeting)

5. Summary and prediction

BTC has climbed back to ~$81k on short covering, two days of ETF inflows and an equity chip rally, but it is still inside the $80-81.5k cost-basis band and below the 20-day EMA, with October red. The options book is call-heavy (P/C 0.53) yet the large calls sit far away at $90-100k, while max pain at $78k sits below price - so options do not push hard either way, and a ~9-point Fed volatility premium is likely to bleed out after tonight and Friday's expiry. The real driver in the next 24 hours is the Fed tone at 02:00 MYT and Thursday's PCE/GDP at 20:30 MYT: a hold with dovish wording can retest $82-84k; hawkish dissents or hot PCE likely retest $79k and the $78k max-pain zone. **24h call: range-bound $79,500-82,500 with a slight upside lean; respect $79.1k as the line in the sand.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: chop	50%	$79,500 - $82,500	Expected hold, mixed Warsh tone, PCE in line; pinning toward max pain into Friday
Bullish	25%	$82,000 - $84,800	Hold without hike dissents, soft PCE; daily close above $82k, ETF inflows continue
Bearish	25%	$77,500 - $79,500	Hawkish dissents / December hike signalled, hot PCE, oil spike; loss of $79.1k

- Bull signal: hourly/daily close above $82,000 with rising OI and positive ETF flows - opens $83.6-84.8k.
- Bear signal: close below $79,100 (Oct 24 low) - opens $78k max pain and then the $75-76.4k zone with put hedging.
- Next report: Thu 29 Oct 7:50am MYT

Sources

Phemex/KuCoin (Deribit via MarsBit) - $11.7B BTC & ETH options expire Friday (Oct 28, 2026): https://phemex.com/news/article/117-billion-in-bitcoin-and-ethereum-options-set-to-expire-friday-on-deribit-101474

CryptoTicker - Bitcoin price prediction: $12.2bn of options expire (Oct 17, 2026): https://cryptoticker.io/en/bitcoin-options-expiry-october-30-2026-max-pain/

MEXC - Bitcoin options expiry calendar (Oct 1, 2026): https://www.mexc.com/crypto-pulse/article/bitcoin-options-expiry-calendar-162666

CoinDesk - Bitcoin tops $81,000 ahead of Fed decision (Oct 28, 2026): https://coindesk.com/markets/2026/10/28/bitcoin-rebounds-above-usd81-000-as-asian-chip-rally-spills-into-crypto-pepe-jumps-9

Coinspeaker - Fed meeting today: rate odds and crypto (Oct 28, 2026): https://www.coinspeaker.com/fed-meeting-rate-odds-crypto/

CryptoSlate - Bitcoin option buyers face a Fed-week premium (Oct 28, 2026): https://cryptoslate.com/bitcoin-option-buyers-face-a-fed-week-premium-that-can-fade-after-the-decision

PANews - $172M crypto futures liquidations, mostly shorts (Oct 28, 2026): https://panews.io/articles/01a18321-e9aa-73c6-9a08-5742f58d9aa0

Mitrade - Bitcoin back above $80,000, 75% of bounce was shorts (Oct 28, 2026): https://www.mitrade.com/insights/crypto-analysis/bitcoin/bitcoin-80000-short-covering-20261028J1354

Cointelegraph - Bitcoin ETFs gain $286M (Oct 28, 2026): https://cointelegraph.com/markets/bitcoin-etf-176-million-inflow-sentiment-rebounds

crypto.news - 14,942 BTC leave exchanges ahead of Fed (Oct 28, 2026): https://crypto.news/bitcoin-price-rebounds-fed-decision-iran-tensions/

Ted Pillows - Crypto & Finance market report (Oct 28, 2026): https://tedpillows.substack.com/p/crypto-and-finance-market-report-127

Coinpedia - Fed decision, GDP data and $12B options expiry loom (Oct 2026): https://coinpedia.org/news/crypto-markets-brace-for-volatility-as-fed-decision-gdp-data-and-12b-bitcoin-options-expiry-loom/

CryptoTicker - Fed rate decision at 7 pm (Oct 28, 2026): https://cryptoticker.io/en/fed-rate-decision-bitcoin-portfolio-october-2026/

ad-hoc-news (Investing.com data) - BTC 81,385.80 (Oct 28, 2026): https://www.ad-hoc-news.de/boerse/news/marktberichte/bitcoin-price-stands-at-81-385-80-usd-with-a-1-88-percent-move/70425455